Boston Children's
Digital Wellness Lab

Young Children and AI

The Youngest Users: Infants & Toddlers
(Data collection late 2023)

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- ***Many young children are accessing AI devices through smart speakers or virtual assistants, but fewer have interacted with GenerativeAI tools.***
- Parents think voice assistants will improve their child's learning and education:
  - **70%** Access to Accurate & Factual Info
  - **68%** Creative Problem-Solving
  - **63%** Focus on Their Homework & Educational Activities

Social-Emotional Behaviors

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- A majority of children aged 3-12 use polite language when speaking to a voice assistant
- Parents feel this type of technology might support family dynamics and social-emotional growth, like improving . . .
  - Family Bonding Activities **(50%)**
  - Understanding and Expression of Emotions **(56%)**
- 50% of parents think GenerativeAI will have a ***positive impact*** on their child's **social skills**

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Adolescents and AI

Top Uses and Concerns of Generative AI
(data collected in 2024)

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- Top 3 uses of GenerativeAI, with adolescents doing each activity at least a few times a week:
  - **52%** Search for Information / Answers
  - **45%** Experiment with the Tools
  - **45%** Research for Homework / School Projects
- Top 3 concerns (Moderate to Extreme Concern)
  - **70%** Creation of Deepfakes
  - **70%** Data and Personal Info Privacy
  - **68%** Use in scams

Social-Emotional Behaviors

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- ***While many teens' use of AI was not monitored or restricted by their parents (self reported), those who did report parental rules around use agrees with those rules and/or expectations.***

  - **53%** Believe GenAI Agents Can Act as a Friend
  - **50%** Believe GenAI improves their social skills
  - **38%** Agree that GenAI can be a substitute for spending time with other people